

AI Governance Framework Series Guide

Implementing Responsible AI Governance in Higher Education Assessment

Version 1.0

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About this Guide

The **AI Governance Framework Series Guide** explains how the seven companion frameworks may be implemented as an integrated institutional system. While each framework can be used independently, the series has been designed to function collectively, supporting assessment design, academic integrity, transparency, professional judgement, and institutional governance.

This guide is intended for programme leaders, educational developers, quality assurance teams, academic integrity professionals, and institutional leaders responsible for implementing responsible AI governance across higher education.

Executive Summary

The AI Governance Framework Series provides a coordinated approach to responsible AI governance in higher education assessment. However, institutions differ considerably in organisational structure, disciplinary practice, assessment traditions, and regulatory requirements. Consequently, implementation should be regarded as an adaptive process rather than a fixed sequence of procedural steps.

This guide outlines practical approaches for introducing the framework series, identifies the primary audience for each framework, recommends phased implementation, and explains how the individual documents support one another. It is intended to help institutions move from isolated AI initiatives towards a coherent educational governance system that preserves academic integrity while supporting meaningful learning.

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1. Purpose of the Guide

The AI Governance Framework Series was developed as a connected set of educational resources rather than a collection of independent documents. Each framework addresses a distinct aspect of responsible AI governance while contributing to a coherent institutional approach.

This guide assists institutions in deciding how, when, and by whom the frameworks may be introduced. It does not prescribe a single implementation model; instead, it offers practical guidance that institutions may adapt according to local priorities, disciplinary contexts, and regulatory requirements.

2. The Framework Series at a Glance

Framework	Primary Purpose
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Framework 1	Conceptual foundation
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Framework 2	Assessment lifecycle implementation
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Framework 3	AI disclosure guidance
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Framework 4	Oral verification
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Framework 5	Authentic assessment design
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Framework 6	Educational risk evaluation
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Framework 7	Institutional governance
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(Insert the "Architecture of the AI Governance Framework Series" infographic here.)

3. Guiding Principles for Implementation

Institutions should implement the framework series according to five principles.

Educational Purpose

The frameworks should support learning before compliance. Educational value should remain central to implementation.

Professional Judgement

The frameworks support professional decision-making but do not replace academic expertise or institutional policy.

Context Sensitivity

Implementation should recognise disciplinary variation, assessment purpose, and local institutional requirements.

Transparency

Expectations regarding AI use should be communicated clearly to students and staff.

Continuous Enhancement

Implementation should be reviewed regularly and refined in response to experience, evidence, and technological developments.

4. Suggested Institutional Implementation

A phased approach is recommended.

Phase 1 – Establish Shared Understanding

Introduce:

- Framework 1
- Framework 2

Objectives:

- develop common terminology;
 - establish governance principles;
 - build institutional awareness.
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Phase 2 – Strengthen Assessment Practice

Introduce:

- Framework 3
- Framework 4
- Framework 5

Objectives:

- improve assessment design;
 - support transparent disclosure;
 - strengthen educational verification.
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Phase 3 – Support Consistent Decision-Making

Introduce:

- Framework 6

Objectives:

- improve consistency;
- support professional judgement;
- promote fair educational responses.

Phase 4 – Institutional Integration

Introduce:

- Framework 7

Objectives:

- embed governance within institutional systems;
 - strengthen quality assurance;
 - establish continuous enhancement.
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5. Suggested Programme-Level Implementation

Programme teams may wish to use the framework series during:

- programme review;
- curriculum redesign;
- assessment mapping;
- moderation meetings;
- annual monitoring;
- quality enhancement activities.

Rather than implementing all seven frameworks simultaneously, programme leaders may begin with the Assessment Integrity Lifecycle and progressively incorporate the companion frameworks as programme practices evolve.

6. Suggested Module-Level Implementation

Individual lecturers are unlikely to require every framework for every assessment.

The following sequence is recommended:

1. Design assessments using the **Assessment Authenticity Checklist**.
2. Communicate AI expectations through the **AI Disclosure Framework**.
3. Evaluate AI use using the **AI Risk-Level Matrix**.
4. Use the **Oral Verification Toolkit** where additional clarification is educationally justified.
5. Review outcomes through the **Assessment Integrity Lifecycle**.

This approach embeds AI governance naturally within assessment practice without introducing unnecessary administrative burden.

7. Matching Frameworks to Professional Roles

Role	Primary Frameworks
Lecturer	3, 4, 5, 6
Programme Leader	2, 5, 6, 7
Assessment Designer	2, 5
Educational Developer	2, 5, 7
Academic Integrity Staff	3, 4, 6
Quality Assurance Team	2, 6, 7
University Leadership	7
Researchers	1

8. Frequently Asked Questions

Must institutions adopt all seven frameworks?

No. Each framework is designed to function independently, although the greatest benefit is achieved when they are implemented as a coordinated system.

Do the frameworks replace institutional policy?

No. They are intended to support institutional policy, professional judgement, and educational practice.

Can the frameworks be adapted?

Yes. Institutions should adapt the frameworks to local disciplinary, regulatory, and organisational contexts while preserving their underlying educational principles.

Are the frameworks empirically validated?

The framework series is conceptual and practice-informed. It has not yet undergone formal empirical validation and should therefore be regarded as a foundation for future institutional implementation and research.

Conclusion

The AI Governance Framework Series provides institutions with a coherent approach to responsible AI governance in higher education assessment. By integrating conceptual principles, practical guidance, decision-support tools, and institutional implementation strategies, the series supports universities in developing governance systems that preserve meaningful learning, academic integrity, and public confidence in higher education qualifications.

Successful implementation depends not upon strict procedural compliance but upon thoughtful adaptation, professional judgement, and continuous educational improvement.

Framework Status

Guide type: Implementation guide

Development status: Conceptual and practice-informed

Validation status: This guide has not yet undergone formal empirical validation. It is intended to support institutional implementation and future empirical evaluation.

Version History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	July 2026	Initial public release.